

Update June 2026

On 20 January 2027, Australia's import conditions for nursery stock will be updated in accordance with the department's [final pest risk analysis for bacterial pathogens in the Xylella genus](#).

Find out how the [updated import conditions](#) may affect you.

Offshore laboratories seeking to conduct testing of plants for Xylella can now apply for registration under the [Xylella Laboratory Authorisation Program](#).

Check Biosecurity Import Conditions ([BICON](#)) for all import conditions applying to your goods.

Tissue-culture plantlets can be imported into Australia either:

- with growing media (in-agar), or
- without growing media (ex-agar)

Import requirements differ depending on the pathways

In-agar tissue culture

Tissue culture imported with growing media may be sourced from any offshore facility, provided the consignment complies with all import conditions in BICON.

Ex-agar tissue culture

Tissue cultures imported without growing media must be sourced from a facility recognised by the department as an approved source.

Tissue cultured plants imported without media from an un-approved facility may require additional onshore measures, including post-entry quarantine in Australia.

If you are unsure whether your tissue culture is in agar or ex agar, we recommend contacting your supplier or the department.

What is an approved source of tissue culture free of media (ex-agar)?

An approved source is an offshore tissue culture production facility that has been assessed and approved by the department for the export of ex-agar tissue culture to Australia.

The department maintains an approved source list in the table below. Consignments imported as ex-agar will be cross-referenced against this approved source list to verify whether the goods are compliant with import conditions.

Importers must also hold a valid import permit and check the specific import conditions for species they wish to import.

Please refer to the department's biosecurity import conditions database for all applicable import conditions – [BICON](#).

What is the approval process?

Facilities seeking recognition as an approved source must submit a formal written application to the department.

Applications are assessed to determine whether the facility has the appropriate systems and controls in place to manage the biosecurity risks in accordance with Australia's appropriate level of protection (ALOP).

Assessments comprise of an end-to-end review and may include:

- document reviews
- systems and traceability assessments
- review of testing and quality assurance arrangements
- engagement with the exporting country National Plant Protection Organisation (NPPO)
- onsite verification activities as required

The department has developed the document [Requirements for facilities to export tissue culture free of media to Australia](#) to support applicants seeking approved source recognition.

Prioritisation of applications

Once a formal application has been received, the department will review all information provided to help inform how the request will be prioritised for completion on our work program.

Applications are prioritised based on the following factors:

- Available departmental resources
- Alignment with departmental work program priorities
- Complexity of application
- Pathway risk
- Projected trade
- Whole of industry benefit
- Readiness of facility to export
- Order of applications received

Assessment timeframe

Timeframes for assessing ex-agar applications may vary depending on:

- The quality and completeness of information provided
- Complexity of production pathways
- Responsiveness of applicants and associated entities
- NPPO engagement
- Competing departmental priorities

The department does not prescribe fixed timeframes for completion of approved source assessments.

Certification periods and ongoing assurance obligations

Approved sources are recognised following successful assessment outcomes.

Recognition remains subject to ongoing compliance with import requirements and pathway assurance outcomes.

The department may undertake:

- Periodic compliance reviews
- Document verification activities
- Targeted audits
- Traceability activities
- Broader verification and inspection activities

Major or repeated non-compliance that is not appropriately remediated, may result in regulatory intervention by the department, including suspension or removal of approval status.

Department approved sources of tissue cultures free of media

Source	Address	Country
	Bagang village, Lubao town,	
Foshan Sanshui Youngplants Co. Ltd	Sanshui District, Foshan City, Guangdong Province 528139	China
Kunming Hasfarm Young Plants Ltd.	Ha Hou Village, Xiao Jie Town, Song Ming County, Kun Min City	China
Shanghai Mother Earth Horticulture Seedlings Co. Ltd	4716 Hunan Rd., Nanhui, Shanghai	China
Sunshine Horticulture Co. Ltd		China

	North Sunshine Road, Shuangyang Town, Luojiang, Quanzhou, Fujian	
BOCK Plants GmbH & Co. KG	Butemdieker, Landstrasse 49A, D-28357 Bremen	Germany
Bangalore Horti Tech	No.19/1, Near Gullahalli gate, Sidlaghatta Road, Sulibele Hobli, Hoskote Taluk, Bangalore Rural - 562122	India
Growmore Biotech Ltd	41-B, Sipcot Phase-II, Hosur – 635 103 (TN) Sr. No. 129/1 to 3 C, Manjri (BK)	India
K.F. Bioplants Pvt Ltd	Tal: Haveli, Dist Pune 412307, (MH)	India
L.J. International Ltd	Plot No. 10 & 11, C. S. E Z, Kakkanad, Cochin-30	India
Paragon Exotic Foliage (India) Pvt Ltd	243/1A1A and 244/1A, Nagondapalli village, Denkanikottai road, Hosur, Tamil Nadu 635110	India
Plantek International	Unit #2 171/1 Arasinakunte, Near rural police station, Nelamangala, Tumkur Road, Bangalore 562 123	India
Rise n' Shine Biotech Pvt. Ltd.	301/2, Metro House, Mangaldas Road, Pune	India
PT. Bambu Nusa Verde	Jl. Mangunan, Tebonan, Harjobinangun, Pakem, Sleman, Yogyakarta 55585	Indonesia
PT Monfori Nusantara	Jl. Raya Jampang Karihkil Km. 4, Desa Tegal Kemang, Parung-Bogor 16310	Indonesia
PT Tamora Stekindo	Jl. Sultan Serdang d/h Jl. Batangkuis, Desa Telaga Sari, Gang Pantai Rantam No. 8, Tanjung Morawa, Medan, 20362, North Sumatera	Indonesia
Micro Pro Orchids	No. 929, Lorong Desa Makmur 3/5, Taman Desa Makmur, 09600 Lunas, Kedah	Malaysia
Vitroflora Philippines Inc.	Purok-6 Brgy Hamorawon, Calbayog City, Western Samar, 6710	Philippines
R&S Tissue Culture Laboratories (Pty) Ltd.	FritzGrub Crescent, Riversdale, Western Cape, South Africa, 6670	South Africa
Perfect Plants (PTY) Ltd.	No. 4, Bloemhof Avenue, Philippi 7750, Cape Town, South Africa, 7808	South Africa
Borneo Exotics (Pvt) Limited	Sandigiri Farm, "Old Colony", Palmerston Junction, Lindula, Sri Lanka	Sri Lanka
Eco-Serene Biotech (Pvt) Ltd.	Kolongasyaya Estate, Matiyagane, Sri Lanka	Sri Lanka
Hayleys Agro Biotech (Pvt) Ltd	400 Dean Road, Colombo-10	Sri Lanka
Mike Biotech Asia (pvt)	No. 65/13, Orchid Place, Off Swarnadisi Place, Koswatta, Nawala, Rajagiriya	Sri Lanka
Ramya Horticulture Pvt. Ltd.		Sri Lanka

	459/1, Kandy Road, Rammuthugala, Kadawata, Sri Lanka	
Serendib Horticulture Technologies (Pvt) Limited	Kandy Road, Kalagedihena, Sri Lanka	Sri Lanka
Grand Biotechnology Co., Ltd.	No. 2 Industry E. Rd. 1, Hsinchu Science Park, Hsinchu	Taiwan
Eastern Green Fields Co. Ltd	27/7 Moo 2, LiabKhlom Sam, Khlom Sam, KhlomLuang, PathumTha Ni 12120	Thailand
Thai Orchids Lab Co. Ltd.	10/14-16 Moo 5, Thakham, Sampran, Nakorn Pathom 73110	Thailand
Hudson Plant Tissue Culture	530 Avalon Drive, Vista, CA 92084	USA
Oglesby Plants International Inc.	26664 SR 71 N, Altha, Florida 32421	USA

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/plant-products/how-to-import-plants/approved-sources-of-tissue-cultures-free-of-media>